Abdulla Muiz Fuad.

Lecturer in Marketing · Tourism, Digital Marketing and SME Development

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Academic profile.

Marketing academic and industry practitioner holding an MSc in Global Marketing Management and a BA (Hons) in Tourism Management, both from Asia Pacific University, Kuala Lumpur. Has taught undergraduate and master's marketing, e-commerce and supply chain modules at MNU Business School and MI College, including subject coordination, assessment design and Applied Project supervision. Co-author of peer-reviewed research on guesthouse tourism and e-marketing in the Maldives (36 citations). Draws on over a decade of marketing and tourism industry experience (since 2011) to ground theory in local business practice.

Research interests: online visibility of small tourism businesses, including in AI-generated answers (generative engine optimisation); booking intermediaries and resource dependence; small island developing states (SIDS); guesthouse and SME development; e-marketing.

Proposed doctoral research (from 2027): "From Rented to Owned Visibility: towards a Maldives Tourism Visibility Observatory". A proposal; the observatory is what the research aims to build, and the first step is a public-data pilot from January 2027. A proposed longitudinal study that builds and validates a multi-channel Visibility Index, applies it each month to a panel of small Maldivian tourism businesses with seasonal owner interviews, and extends resource dependence theory to algorithmic intermediaries such as AI assistants.

Next steps: Preparing PhD applications to UPM and UTM. From January 2027, a public-data pilot will produce a working paper with an open dataset and a research note targeting *Information Technology & Tourism* (Q1, Scopus-indexed).

Teaching areas: Introduction to Marketing; International Marketing; Electronic Marketing; Brand Management; Business Entrepreneurship; E-commerce; Digital Marketing; Supply Chain Management.

Education.

MSc Global Marketing Management — 2016 – 2018
Asia Pacific University · Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

BA (Hons) Tourism Management — 2014 – 2016
Asia Pacific University · Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

Diploma Level 4 in Tourism Management — 2012 – 2013
MAPS College · Malé, Maldives · Affiliate: Confederation of Tourism and Hospitality (CTH), UK

Diploma in Human Resources Management — 2011
Clique College · Malé, Maldives · Affiliate: Association of Business Executives (ABE), UK

Diploma in Business with Information Technology — 2008 – 2010
Asia Pacific University · Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

Academic experience.

Lecturer — Nov 2026 – present
MNU Business School, The Maldives National University · Malé, Maldives

- Teaching and coordinating undergraduate marketing modules.

Associate Lecturer and Subject Coordinator — Oct 2024 – Oct 2026
MNU Business School, The Maldives National University · Malé, Maldives

- Full-time; taught and coordinated undergraduate modules: MKT101 Introduction to Marketing, MKT213 Integrated Marketing Communication, MKT217 Advertising and Promotion, MKT301 International Marketing, MKT303 Electronic Marketing and MKT309 Brand Management; also lectured Business Entrepreneurship and Maldivian Business Environment.

- As subject coordinator, responsible for the syllabus and learning outcomes, assessment setting and rubric moderation, exam papers and marking guides, Moodle course design, tutor standardisation, study guides and Applied Project supervision.
- Embedded real Maldivian business cases into course material to link theoretical frameworks to local industry practice.

Part-time Lecturer 2022 – 2024

MI College · Malé, Maldives

- Taught Digital Marketing & Ecommerce (master's, level 500), Supply Chain Management (level 300) and Introduction to Marketing and Communication (level 100), online and in person.
- Revised and modernised inherited course materials to reflect current industry developments.
- Prepared exam papers; designed tutorials, workshops and assignments built around contemporary industry trends.

Publications.

Google Scholar: iocdrp.s.gy/fuad-a-m

- Chia, K. W., & Muiz, A. (2021). The nature and challenges of guest house business in the Maldives: An exploratory study. *Tourism and Hospitality Research, 21*(1), 3–14. https://doi.org/10.1177/1467358420926688 (cited 36 times). Indexed in Scopus and Web of Science (ESCI).
- CM Pappayah, P. P., Muiz, A., & Jinus, D. J. (2017). Increasing the visibility of guesthouse operation in the Maldives through e-marketing. *Journal of Tourism and Leisure Studies, 2*(2), 11–20. https://doi.org/10.18848/2470-9336/CGP/v02i02/11-20

Published as A. Muiz.

Service and supervision.

- Subject coordinator for six modules
- Assessment validation for coordinated subjects
- Peer evaluation of two colleagues' teaching (2025)
- Member, MNU Business School Marketing Committee
- Member, MSME Awards committee (Business Centre Corporation, with MIRA, the Ministry and MNU), 2025
- Exam paper setting and moderation, including the combined MKT101 paper with a co-lecturer
- Undergraduate applied projects: learning-contract advice, progress meetings, report review and presentation coaching; three supervised to completion (2025 to 2026), three in progress. Featured: Safe Steps, a child-safety campaign for a national ministry.

Conference presentations.

- Presented a conceptual paper on Sustainable Development of Local Island Tourism, 3rd International Hospitality and Tourism Conference (IHTC), 2016.

Professional experience.

Manager, SME HUB 2024

Business Centre Corporation · Malé, Maldives

- Managed an MSME business incubator (Ministry of Economic Development initiative under the MEERY Project), supporting 23 active vendors through a one-year incubation period.
- Led digital and traditional marketing campaigns, market analysis, budgeting and partnership development.

Sales and Marketing Manager, Maldives Business Network (MBN) 2023 – 2024

Business Centre Corporation · Malé, Maldives

- Marketed a business TV channel created to promote financial literacy; introduced web series and social media formats to reach a younger audience.
- Led marketing strategy, market research, sales forecasting and client relations, securing key partnerships and growing advertising sales.

Manager, Customer Relations and Clinical Operations — 2022 – 2023

Thiba Psychology · Malé, Maldives

- Managed customer service and clinical staff, service workflows and process improvements; strengthened community presence through social media marketing.

Marketing Manager — 2021 – 2022

Reethi Beach Resort · Baa Atoll, Maldives

- Led the resort's marketing function, with annual social media strategies targeting source markets including Germany and Italy.
- Ran a multi-tiered influencer programme (including Miss Germany 2022, Domitila Barros, on coral conservation and reef restoration), with TV, creator and print partnerships reaching European and Asian platforms such as VK, Xiaohongshu and Douyin.
- Improved organic search performance through blog content and high-authority travel features; tracked campaigns in Google Analytics; managed newsletters and repeat-guest email.
- Contributed to the website redesign (UI/UX), created new room category tiers and developed in-property events that grew F&B revenue; represented the resort at international trade fairs.

Copywriter — 2020 – 2021

Maldives Ports Limited · Malé, Maldives

- Wrote web content and newsletters, published data-driven operational reports, and ran a social media campaign on MPL's workforce.

Head of Operations / Creative Director — 2018 – 2020

Blazon.Inc · Malé, Maldives

- Led the marketing and design teams; oversaw corporate identities, in-house publications and contracted in-flight magazines; hosted two consecutive Annual Maldives Business Awards.

Earlier roles — 2011 – 2017

- **Apprentice Layout Designer**, Tourism Publication Corporation Sdn. Bhd, Kuala Lumpur (2015–2017)
- **Cargo Officer**, Maldives Airports Company (2013–2014)
- **Marketing Officer**, Highrise Inc (2011–2013): sold advertising for Floating Asia and Visiting Guide; marketed MATATO Maldives Travel Awards and Living Expo
- **Marketing Associate**, Global Safety Associates (2011–2012)

Selected industry engagement.

- **MATTA Fair, Kuala Lumpur (2014–2018):** progressed from promoter (2014) to Marketing Coordinator (2015) and Head of Marketing and Sales (2017) for MP Travel and Tours; led the Exhibitor Coordination Committee in 2018.
- **Events (2012–2024):** Maldives Business Awards 2019 (Event Manager); MATATO Maldives Travel Awards 2012 (Event Coordinator); Living Expo; MAHA Portal Launch and Vunadhaana Festival (BCC).
- **Content and strategy (2022):** Content Creator and Social Media Strategist for Miss Germany 2022, Domitila Barros (Maldives).
- **Volunteer:** 6th Global Summit on Urban Tourism (2017).

Referees.

Available on request.

Warm regards,

Abdulla Muiz Fuad

LECTURER IN MARKETING · MNU BUSINESS SCHOOL